

EGGLESS MOIST DARK CHOCOLATE CAKE

With glossy chocolate sauce & a generous chocolate-chip finish

THE CURLY CHEF RECIPE CARD | Beginner-friendly, bakery-style method

A soft, deeply chocolatey cake with a tender crumb—finished with warm, silky sauce that soaks into every slice and pools generously around the plate.

Yield: One 15 cm / 6-inch round cake (about 6–8 servings) **Oven: 170°C conventional / 160°C fan**

1. Recipe Overview

This recipe is designed for a moist, eggless chocolate cake with a soft crumb. Yogurt helps provide tenderness and structure; baking soda reacts with the yogurt and vinegar; oil keeps the cake soft after cooling; hot coffee deepens the chocolate flavour without making the cake taste strongly of coffee. Use hot water if you prefer.

Important: the batter is meant to be fairly fluid. Do not add extra flour just because it looks thinner than a butter cake batter.

2. Ingredients

A. Cake

Ingredient	Quantity	Notes
Plain flour	150 g	All-purpose flour; sift if lumpy.
Unsweetened cocoa powder	35 g	Natural cocoa is suitable; Dutch-process may give a different rise depending on acidity.
Caster sugar	170 g	Fine granulated sugar can be used.
Baking powder	5 g	Fresh and in date.
Baking soda	3 g	Do not confuse with baking powder.
Fine salt	2 g	Balances sweetness.
Plain unsweetened full-fat yogurt	120 g	Stir smooth before using; not flavoured or sweetened.
Full-fat milk	120 g	Room temperature is easiest to combine.
Neutral oil	80 g	Sunflower, canola or another neutral oil.
Vanilla extract	5 g	About 1 tsp.
White vinegar	5 g	About 1 tsp; helps acidity and leavening.
Hot brewed coffee or hot water	100 g	Hot, not violently boiling; add carefully.

B. Glossy chocolate sauce

Ingredient	Quantity	Notes
Dark couverture chocolate (55–65%)	100 g	Chop finely for even melting.
Heavy cream (30–35% fat)	100 g	Heat until steaming, not boiling.
Unsalted butter	10 g	Adds shine and a softer finish.
Fine salt	0.5 g	A small pinch.
Glucose or golden syrup (optional)	10 g	Helps shine and smoothness; omit if unavailable.

C. Topping

- 30 g dark chocolate chips + 20 g milk chocolate chips, for the whole cake. Add at serving time for the best texture.

3. Equipment

- 15 cm / 6-inch round cake tin with parchment paper on the base.
- Two mixing bowls, fine sieve, whisk and flexible spatula.
- Kitchen scale for accurate recipe preparation.
- Oven and oven mitts.
- Small heatproof bowl for the sauce and a spoon or spatula for stirring.
- Cooling rack, serrated knife and serving plate.

4. Step-by-Step Cake Method

Step 1. Prepare the tin and oven. Line the base of a 15 cm / 6-inch round tin with parchment paper. Lightly grease the sides if needed. Preheat the oven to 170°C conventional or 160°C fan. Make sure the rack is in the middle.

Step 2. Sift and combine the dry ingredients. Sift the flour and cocoa into a bowl. Add caster sugar, baking powder, baking soda and salt. Whisk for 20–30 seconds so the raising agents are evenly distributed.

Step 3. Mix the wet ingredients. In a separate bowl, whisk the yogurt until smooth. Add milk, oil, vanilla and vinegar. Whisk until evenly combined; it should look like a smooth, pale liquid mixture.

Step 4. Combine wet and dry. Pour the wet mixture into the dry ingredients. Whisk gently until most of the dry patches disappear. Scrape the sides and base of the bowl once.

Step 5. Add hot coffee or water. Pour in the hot coffee or water gradually while whisking gently. Stop as soon as the batter is smooth. It will be more fluid than a typical butter cake batter; that is intentional.

Step 6. Fill the tin. Pour the batter into the prepared tin. Tap the tin gently once on the counter to release large air pockets. Do not repeatedly bang it.

Step 7. Bake. Bake for about 35–45 minutes. Begin checking at 33–35 minutes because ovens vary. The top should look set, and a wooden skewer inserted in the centre should come out without raw batter; a few moist crumbs are fine.

Step 8. Cool before removing. Rest in the tin for 10–15 minutes. Run a thin knife around the edge if needed, then carefully turn out and remove the parchment. Cool completely on a rack before cutting or adding sauce.

5. Glossy Chocolate Sauce

Sauce step 1. Chop the chocolate. Put the finely chopped couverture chocolate in a dry, heatproof bowl.

Sauce step 2. Heat the cream. Warm the cream with the optional glucose/golden syrup until steaming around the edges. Do not boil vigorously.

Sauce step 3. Make the emulsion. Pour the hot cream over the chocolate. Leave undisturbed for 60–90 seconds, then stir slowly from the centre in small circles. Gradually widen the circles until the sauce is smooth and glossy.

Sauce step 4. Finish. Stir in the butter and salt until fully incorporated. If the sauce looks too thick, add a little warm cream; if too thin, allow it to cool briefly. Avoid adding cold liquid all at once.

6. How to Make It Extra Chocolate-Soaked

For the indulgent, heavily sauced serving shown in your video, the sauce should soak into the cut face of the cake—not just sit on top. Use the following serving method for each slice:

- Let the cake cool completely before slicing, so the crumb stays tender and does not collapse.
- Cut a thick slice with a sharp serrated knife and place it on a shallow plate or small bowl.
- Warm the sauce gently until it flows in a thick ribbon. It should be warm, not scorching hot.
- Pour a generous amount over the top, then direct some sauce over the exposed cut face. Allow 20–30 seconds for it to absorb.
- Pour a second layer over the slice. Let excess sauce flow down the sides and pool around the base.
- Finish with dark and milk chocolate chips while the sauce is still glossy.
- Serve immediately. For an even more saturated result, reserve extra sauce at the table and pour a little more just before serving.

Texture goal: the cake should remain a sliceable sponge, but its exposed crumb should look darker and moist from absorbed sauce. The plate should have a generous pool of sauce. Do not pour boiling sauce onto the cake.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely reason	What to do next time
Cake is dense or gummy	Overmixing, underbaking or inaccurate flour measurement.	Mix only until smooth; check the centre with a skewer; weigh ingredients.
Cake sinks in the centre	Oven door opened too early, underbaking or raising agents too old.	Avoid opening early; check oven temperature and freshness of leaveners.
Cake is dry	Overbaking or incorrect tin size.	Begin checking at 33–35 minutes; use the specified 15 cm tin.
Sauce is too thick	It has cooled or chocolate percentage is high.	Warm gently; add a little warm cream if needed.
Sauce looks oily or split	Overheating or poor emulsification.	Stir slowly from the centre; if needed, whisk in a teaspoon of warm cream.

8. Storage and Serving

- Store the plain, cooled cake in an airtight container at room temperature for up to 2 days in a cool environment, or refrigerate for about 4 days. Refrigeration can firm the crumb; bring it closer to room temperature before serving.
- Store leftover cream-based chocolate sauce in a covered container in the refrigerator and use within 3–4 days. Rewarm gently, stirring until smooth; do not repeatedly heat and cool it.
- For the best extra-saucy serving, warm only the portion of sauce you need and add the chocolate chips immediately before serving.

THE CURLY CHEF — Eggless baking, crafted with care.

Recipe note: oven performance, cocoa type and chocolate brands can affect results. Use the stated temperatures as a starting point and rely on the doneness checks for the best outcome.